

MI.4 Where to File Directory

Michigan's hardest question is not what the rules are — it is who enforces them on your parcel. This document answers it, per trade, and gives you a page to write down what you confirmed.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Michigan's construction code is a single statewide code, but it is administered by more than 1,800 separate units of government — and your township, city, county, or the state Bureau of Construction Codes may each enforce a different trade on the same parcel. Confirm every item with the enforcing agency that will actually issue your permit before you rely on it.

ONE CODE, THREE POSSIBLE ENFORCERS, FOUR SEPARATE ANSWERS

Michigan's construction code is a single statewide code. Its **administration** is not. Every unit of government in the state — every township, city and village — is listed against **four disciplines**: building, electrical, mechanical and plumbing. Each of the four is separately assigned to one of three levels.

The three levels, in the Bureau's own words

If the list says	What it means
LOCAL	That city, township or village runs its own program and issues that permit itself.
COUNTY	That unit of government receives code enforcement services from a county enforcing agency — so you file with the county, not the township.
STATE	The Bureau of Construction Codes is responsible for code enforcement there. You file with the State of Michigan in Lansing, and a state inspector drives to your site.

The mistake this document exists to prevent

Because the four disciplines are assigned separately, **your building permit and your plumbing permit may come from different governments**. That is not a rare edge case. Working through the Bureau's own list for all 1,824 units of government in Michigan, **252 of them — about one in seven — have at least one discipline assigned to a different agency than the others**.

The pattern is lopsided in a way that matters to you. The State is the **building** enforcing agency for only 59 units of government, but the **plumbing** enforcing agency for 264 and the **mechanical** enforcing agency for 241. So the common rural case is not "the state does everything" — it is a county building department that will happily take your building permit, and a state plumbing inspector out of Lansing who has never heard of your project. Check all four before you file any of them.

THE STATEWIDE JURISDICTION LIST — HOW TO USE IT

The Bureau publishes the answer for every unit of government in Michigan in one PDF, free. It is the single most useful document in Michigan owner-building and almost nobody outside the trade knows it exists. Find it at michigan.gov/lara → Bureau of Construction Codes, where it is linked from every permit information page, or search "*Michigan Statewide Jurisdiction List*."

- ☐ Find the **county** your parcel is in — the list is ordered by county, then by unit of government within it.
- ☐ Find your exact **unit of government**: the township, city or village your parcel sits in. This is not always the mailing address on your deed — a rural address often carries a nearby city's post office name while the parcel is in a township.
- ☐ Read **all four columns** across that one row — BLDG, ELEC, MECH, PLBG — and write each answer into the directory on the next page.
- ☐ Check for a **date under any column**. The list prints the effective date of a change directly below the level of jurisdiction, so a recent handover is visible on the row itself.
- ☐ Check for an **asterisk**. An asterisk means the Bureau is temporarily assisting a local agency; the detail is spelled out at the end of the list under "Assistance to Local Enforcing Agency."

It changes — and it changed this year

The Bureau updates the list "*after every Construction Code Commission meeting to show changes; i.e. units of government which have newly assumed responsibility or those who have returned responsibility to the state or county level.*" This is not a static reference.

A live example from the current revision: **every unit of government in Luce County — the county itself, the Village of Newberry, and its townships — moved to STATE enforcement for all four disciplines effective 01/01/2026**. An owner-builder there who relied on a two-year-old answer, or on what a neighbor did, would file with an office that no longer handles it. **Download the list the week you file, not the year you start planning.**

Bureau of Construction Codes, Statewide Jurisdiction List, revision 8/21/2026, read 27 August 2026. Quotations are from the explanatory page at the front of that document. The counts in this document (1,824 units of government across 83 counties; 252 with a split assignment; state-enforced counts of 59 building, 184 electrical, 241 mechanical, 264 plumbing) were derived by tallying that revision of the list and will drift as units of government change level — treat them as a picture of how common the problem is, not as a lookup. Your row is the only one that governs.

THE OFFICES THE JURISDICTION LIST DOES NOT COVER

The list settles the four construction permits. It says nothing about the five environmental approvals in MI.2, and those are assigned by entirely different statutes — so they can land on a fifth and sixth office again.

Finding the right office for your parcel

Office	How to find it
Zoning (use, setbacks, height, lot coverage)	Always your township, city or village — never the State, and not preempted by the construction code. Search "[your township] MI zoning." Ask for the setbacks in writing before you draw.
County or district health department (septic, private well)	Some Michigan counties have their own health department; many share a multi-county district health department. Search "[your county] MI health department environmental health" and confirm which body serves your county.
Soil erosion (Part 91)	The county enforces throughout the county unless your municipality has adopted its own department-approved ordinance, which may be stricter. Ask the county first; they will tell you if your municipality has taken it over.
County road commission (driveway / road tie-in)	Michigan county road commissions are separate bodies from the county government and issue their own driveway permits. If you connect to a state trunkline (an I-, US- or M- numbered route) it is MDOT instead — michigan.gov/mdot.
Fire district	Your local fire authority signs the fire district line on the permit application. On a rural parcel expect questions about access width, turnaround and water supply.
EGLE (wetlands, inland lakes and streams, floodplain, shoreline)	The Department of Environment, Great Lakes, and Energy — michigan.gov/egle — permits work in regulated wetlands, near inland lakes and streams, in floodplains, and on high-risk erosion and critical dune areas. If any part of your parcel is wet or near water, ask <i>before</i> you design the driveway.

YOUR DIRECTORY — FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU NEED IT

Start with the four construction permits, because in Michigan they are four separate answers. Write the **level** you read off the Statewide Jurisdiction List (LOCAL, COUNTY or STATE) and then the office that level actually means for your parcel. Confirm each by phone rather than copying it from a search result, and note the name of the person you spoke to — in a township office, a name is worth more than a number.

BUILDING PERMIT — plan review, footings through final, the CO

Level (LOCAL / COUNTY / STATE): _____ Office: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

ELECTRICAL PERMIT — service, rough-in, final — often a different agency than building

Level (LOCAL / COUNTY / STATE): _____ Office: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

MECHANICAL PERMIT — heating, ductwork, fuel gas

Level (LOCAL / COUNTY / STATE): _____ Office: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

PLUMBING PERMIT — water, waste, vent, building sewer

Level (LOCAL / COUNTY / STATE): _____ Office: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

ZONING — township / city / village — setbacks, use, address assignment

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

HEALTH DEPARTMENT — septic and private well — county or district

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

SOIL EROSION (PART 91) — county, unless your municipality has assumed it

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

COUNTY ROAD COMMISSION — driveway permit — or MDOT on a state trunkline

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

FIRE DISTRICT — access, turnaround, water supply

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

ELECTRIC UTILITY — temporary construction power and permanent service

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

WATER & SEWER — public connection, tap fees — or N/A if well/septic

Office / department: _____ Phone: _____

Portal / address: _____ Spoke with: _____ Confirmed: _____

STATE-LEVEL CONTACTS

These are stable and worth knowing. Phone numbers are left for you to confirm — a wrong number printed in a kit is worse than no number.

State agencies and what each is actually for

Agency	Why you would contact them	Website
LARA Bureau of Construction Codes	Publishes the Statewide Jurisdiction List and the code rules; issues permits and inspects wherever the list says STATE; licenses residential builders and the skilled trades. Also where you verify that a contractor you are hiring is actually licensed.	michigan.gov/bcc
Michigan Construction Code Commission	Hears construction code appeals, and is the body whose meetings trigger each revision of the Statewide Jurisdiction List. Reached through the Bureau.	michigan.gov/bcc
Michigan Legislature	The statutes themselves, free and current: the Occupational Code (1980 PA 299, Article 24 — residential builders), the Stille-DeRossett-Hale Act (1972 PA 230 — permits, enforcing agencies), and NREPA Part 91 (1994 PA 451 — soil erosion).	legislature.mi.gov
EGLE	Wetlands, inland lakes and streams, floodplain, high-risk erosion and critical dune permits; the state radon program.	michigan.gov/egle

Sources (verified August 2026). The three jurisdiction levels and the update cadence: Bureau of Construction Codes, Statewide Jurisdiction List, explanatory page, rev. 8/21/2026. Application goes to "the appropriate enforcing agency": MCL 125.1510(1), and the Bureau's own instruction on form BCC-324 (04/2024) — "A permit application must be submitted to the appropriate enforcing agency based upon these lists." Soil erosion is enforced by the county throughout the county unless a municipality has an approved ordinance: MCL 324.9105(1), 324.9106. Statutes at legislature.mi.gov.